

Creator Ads Interview Analysis — Operations Perspective

A Second Creator Ads Interview, Cross-Checked Against Prior Findings

Interview with Lidia Nascimento (Campaign Operations Lead, Creator Ads) • September 15, 2026 • Conducted and analyzed by Kaiane Souza

1. Purpose and Sources

This document analyzes the third interview in Aurora's market validation round, and the second conducted at Creator Ads — this time with Lidia Nascimento, who leads campaign operations, rather than Kevin Ramlow, who works in Go-to-Market Engineering. Because both interviews are with the same company, this report places special emphasis on where the two accounts agree or diverge, in addition to validating Aurora's hypotheses.

Four sources were used: (1) the interview question script, organized into five thematic blocks (market growth, client profile, automation, creator dynamics, and agency role); (2) personal notes taken during the conversation; (3) an automatically generated meeting summary; and (4) the full interview transcript, delivered together with the summary in a single Gemini-generated document. Where sources diverged in detail, the transcript was treated as the primary source of record.

2. Lidia's Role and Creator Ads' Origin

Lidia Nascimento has worked at Creator Ads for two years, having joined shortly after the company pivoted away from an affiliate-marketing model toward treating creators as a media asset in their own right, rather than as sales agents. Her background is in regional sales and operations at traditional consumer companies, not in media or technology, which she frames as an asset: the sector moves fast enough that continuous technical adaptability matters more than tenure or legacy playbooks.

Operationally, she owns the translation of a closed sales briefing into a running campaign: she meets with the client to understand the success metric that matters to them — which varies by client (e.g., Unilever and L'Oréal are described as optimizing specifically for mention volume on Reels, TikTok, and Shorts, explicitly excluding Stories) — and translates that into a creator brief. Her analysts then execute day-to-day creator management through to campaign completion, while she owns client-facing strategy, including whether to extend or resell a campaign that is performing well.

3. Campaign Curation and the Acceptance Funnel

Creator selection runs through proprietary technology that profiles creators based on signals from their connected social accounts (the example given: a creator who posts about a red car will surface for briefs targeting car owners). A typical campaign funnel starts with roughly 500 creators contacted, of which about 100 accept; roughly 20 of those subsequently drop out and are backfilled from a waitlist of creators who had not made the initial cut, in order to still land on the contracted headcount.

4. Market Barriers: Risk Perception and Structural Incentives

Lidia's explanation of the 2.7% figure (Exame, 2025, citing Kantar Ibope Media and Statista) differs in emphasis from Kevin's. Where Kevin framed the barrier mainly as a measurement problem, Lidia frames it as a risk-perception problem: executives view creators as "easy to administer, high risk" because a creator is a person who can become embroiled in controversy (she cited the case of the influencer Virgínia as the kind of scenario budget owners fear), whereas traditional media is viewed as "hard to administer, low risk." A risk-averse budget owner defaults to the channel that will not put their own job at risk, even if it is measurably less effective.

She also raised a structural point not present in either prior interview: traditional media carries long-standing, informally accepted commission and kickback arrangements ("repasses") between media buyers and vendors that the creator economy does not replicate, which she argues gives incumbents a quiet incentive to protect the status quo. She frames her own work, more broadly, as shifting ad spend away from a small number of concentrated broadcasters toward thousands of individual creators — a form of income redistribution she sees as a genuine structural shift, not only a media-buying trend.

5. Minimum Investment and the TV Comparison

Lidia cited a minimum investment of R\$50,000 for mid-market clients (a higher, undisclosed minimum applies to larger brands). She justified this by contrasting it with traditional TV: a single 30-second spot on a mainstream broadcaster, in her account, does not build the repeat exposure needed to influence a purchase decision, which she put at roughly six touchpoints on average (citing the shoe brand Ludd as an example of frequency-driven demand generation). With the same R\$50,000 on Creator Ads, a brand can fund roughly 50 pieces of content, each boosted independently, generating many more discrete touchpoints at a lower cost-per-view than a single TV placement — she also noted that producing just one 30-second TV commercial cost close to R\$100,000 early in her career, before any media placement was even purchased.

6. Self-Service, and Human-Led Real-Time Optimization

As with Kevin's account, there is no self-service today, and Lidia was more explicit about why: she described it as a "double-edged sword" — without her team's curation layer, a brand could reject content based on the personal taste of whoever is reviewing it rather than actual brand strategy, or expose itself to reputational risk from a creator misstep with no filter in place. All campaigns route through her team specifically to keep that judgment centralized.

On real-time optimization, her account closely matches Kevin's independent description at the company level: roughly 10–20% of creators who miss a delivery deadline are removed mid-campaign and replaced, and the replacement profile can be redirected toward a better-performing content cluster (e.g., shifting from a beauty niche to a humor niche if humor content is converting better). Two details are new here: first, she confirmed this reallocation decision is made by her team today, not by AI ("hoje somos nós"); second, she noted the client is often not aware a swap has happened, since account managers on the brand side are typically responsible for many things besides the influencer campaign and would not notice at that level of granularity. AI is used, separately, to source new creator profiles that resemble a defined target via semantic search over each creator's API-connected content history — and she offered a specific prompting practice: defining what the system should exclude ("don'ts") in detail while keeping permitted criteria ("dos") minimal, since an overly permissive prompt tends to confuse the matching logic.

7. Creator Acquisition and Creator Pay — A Direct Validation of Duda's Core Pain

Creators join by connecting their Meta, TikTok, or Google accounts via API, granting Creator Ads continuous visibility into their published content for matching purposes — described as equivalent to any standard social-login OAuth flow. Reported reasons creators decline offered jobs are financial (the offer is below their rate) or a lack of identification with the brand; rejection rates are notably high for categories such as betting/gambling brands.

The most strategically important new finding in this interview is **Creator Pay**: through a financial partner, creators can request an advance on their receivables and be paid within 24 hours, in exchange for a percentage fee — comparable to a card-machine cash-advance product — instead of waiting the brand's standard 60–90 day payment terms. Lidia described this as a benefit no other company in the market currently offers, and credited it as a major driver of creator signups, particularly for creators outside major urban centers who depend on that cash flow. This directly answers Duda's persona pain point (see Table 3) in a way neither prior interview surfaced.

8. Agencies — A Third Independent Confirmation of Hypothesis A

Traditional media agencies are confirmed once again as clients: they purchase job packages from Creator Ads the same way an ordinary brand would. Lidia gave a concrete mechanism: an agency holding, for example, a R\$5 million global campaign budget for a brand might carve out roughly R\$1 million specifically for micro/nano-creator activity — secondary content such as reaction videos, skits, or spin-offs supporting the main campaign — and bring that slice to Creator Ads directly. This is the third independent account (after Kevin at Creator Ads and Gabriel at PlayNest) describing agencies as intermediated clients rather than competitors, now with a concrete budget-split example.

9. Internal Consistency Check: Kevin vs. Lidia (Both Creator Ads)

Table 1

Where the Two Creator Ads Interviews Agree and Diverge

Topic	Kevin (GTM Engineering)	Lidia (Operations)
Mid-campaign optimization	Budget reallocated toward boosting top-performing content; decision made jointly with the brand.	10–20% of underperforming creators swapped for better-performing cluster profiles; decision made internally, often without the client's awareness.
Self-service	Framed as a product-readiness question; piloted, exploring agent-first (MCP) future.	Framed as a brand-risk and quality-control question; explicitly called a "double-edged sword."
Agencies	Clients/bridges; competitors only if scaling manually without tech.	Clients; concrete example of a brand's agency carving out a budget slice (R\$1M of R\$5M) for micro/nano.

2.7% market gap — cause	Framed primarily as a measurement/ROI-proof problem.	Framed primarily as risk-perception and structural incentive problems (agency kickbacks, executive risk-aversion).
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Note. The two accounts are complementary rather than contradictory: both confirm the same underlying mechanisms (mid-campaign swaps, no self-service, agencies as clients) while emphasizing different causes and owners, consistent with their different functional roles.

10. Three-Way Comparison: Creator Ads vs. PlayNest

Table 2
Consolidated Creator Ads View (Kevin + Lidia) vs. PlayNest (Gabriel)

Dimension	Creator Ads (consolidated)	PlayNest
Minimum investment	R\$50,000 for mid-market clients (higher, undisclosed floor for larger brands).	R\$30,000–50,000, split by approval-flow format.
Creator payment differentiator	Creator Pay: 24-hour receivables advance for a fee, described as unique in the market.	Not discussed; differentiator emphasized instead is coaching/community support.
Self-service	None; piloted; two internal framings (product-readiness vs. brand-risk).	None, by deliberate choice, for the same brand-risk reasons Lidia gave.
Agencies	Clients, confirmed independently by two roles at the same company.	Clients, confirmed by the founder-level interview.

Note. With three interviews now complete, Hypothesis A (agencies as clients) has been confirmed independently four times across two companies and three different roles.

11. Cross-Check Against Aurora's Personas

Table 3
Persona Assumptions Compared to Findings Across All Three Interviews

Persona	Assumed pain	Status after this interview
Marina (brand)	Wants predictable, programmatic-style pricing for nano/micro creators.	Still unresolved: pricing logic remains opaque to the brand across all three interviews so far.
Duda (creator)	Wants fast, transparent, fair payment.	Strongly validated and partially solved by the market leader. Creator Pay directly answers the payment-speed dimension of this pain, though only in exchange for a fee — the underlying 60–90 day brand payment term it works around is itself evidence the pain is real.
Renata (agency)	Fears disintermediation; wants multi-client/white-label management with protected margin.	Confirmed a third time, now with a concrete budget-split mechanism (R\$1M of R\$5M) illustrating how the intermediation actually works financially.

12. Implications for Aurora

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- **Creator Pay is the single most important competitive signal collected so far.** If instant/fast payment is genuinely unique to Creator Ads in this market, and creators cite it as a primary reason to sign up, a comparable payment mechanism could be one of Aurora's strongest creator-side acquisition levers rather than a nice-to-have feature.
 - **Pricing opacity toward the brand remains an open gap across every interview to date.** Three separate conversations, two companies, and no one has described giving Marina-equivalent clients granular, predictable pricing visibility — this continues to look like real white space rather than a solved problem the market has simply chosen not to discuss.
 - **Mid-campaign reallocation is consistently manual across both companies interviewed.** Two independent Creator Ads roles and PlayNest all describe this as human-run today; automating the reallocation decision itself (not just the creator-matching step) looks like a genuinely open technical opportunity, not something a competitor has already claimed.
 - **The traditional-media kickback dynamic is worth watching as a headwind, not just a market-education problem.** If structural incentives inside media-buying agencies favor the status quo independent of measurable performance, education alone may not shift budget as fast as performance data would predict — useful to factor into how aggressively Aurora should expect ad-budget migration to happen.
 - **Hypothesis A is now confirmed four times over.** Agencies as intermediated clients should be treated as a settled, low-risk assumption in Aurora's planning going forward.

13. Limitations

This analysis rests on a single interview with one Creator Ads operations lead; figures such as the 500/100/20 acceptance funnel, the 10–20% mid-campaign replacement rate, and the specifics of Creator Pay's fee structure are self-reported and were not independently verified. Because Lidia and Kevin hold different roles at the same company, apparent agreement between their accounts strengthens confidence in the underlying facts, but should not be read as two fully independent data points on company-wide strategy.

References

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